



Q

**What is the recommended headspace to leave when canning fruits in jars?**



## ANSWER

**1/2 inch**

## FUN FACT

*Proper headspace helps ensure a vacuum seal and prevents spoilage.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

**Q**

**Which method of packing fruit usually results in less floating fruit and better color protection?**



Adults

## ANSWER

### Hot pack

## FUN FACT

*Heating fruits before packing allows firmer, better-looking canned fruit.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

**Q**

**When water bath canning fruits, how far above the jar tops should the boiling water be in the canner?**

# CANNING FRUITS



Adults

## ANSWER

**1 to 2 inches**

## FUN FACT

*Keeping water above jars during processing ensures even heating and safe preservation.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

**Q**

**For raw-packed fruit in canning jars, at what minimum water temperature should the jars be preheated before filling?**

# CANNING FRUITS



Adults

## ANSWER

**140°F**

## FUN FACT

*Preheating jars reduces the risk of breakage when filled with hot syrup or juice.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits





**Q**

**Why should you not retighten screw bands on jars after processing and cooling?**



## ANSWER

**Retightening can cut the lid gasket and cause seal failure**

## FUN FACT

*Proper lid tightness is critical for safe sealing and food preservation.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

**Q**

**What is the function of sugar syrup in canning fruits?**



## ANSWER

**It helps retain shape, texture,  
and color of the fruit**

## FUN FACT

*You can safely omit sugar syrup and  
use water or juice instead for  
preservation.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

## Q

**If a jar fails to seal after processing, what is the recommended action?**

## ANSWER

**Refrigerate and use soon or reprocess within 24 hours with a new lid**

## FUN FACT

*Reprocessing with a new lid ensures safety and quality of canned fruit.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

**Q**

**What type of jars are best suited for home canning fruit?**



## ANSWER

### Standard Mason jars

## FUN FACT

*Mason jars are specifically tempered to withstand canning heat and seal properly.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**When using raw pack method for canning fruit, what temperature should the syrup or juice added be?**



Adults

## ANSWER

### Boiling

## FUN FACT

*Using boiling syrup or juice prevents a temperature shock that could break jars.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**How long should empty jars be sterilized if processing for less than 10 minutes?**

# CANNING FRUITS



Adults

## ANSWER

**Boil for 10 minutes**

## FUN FACT

*Sterilization ensures jars are free of microbes, protecting food safety.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**What is a sign that a metal lid has successfully sealed on a canned fruit jar?**



## ANSWER

**The lid is concave and does not move when pressed**

## FUN FACT

*A sealed lid gives an audible ring when tapped, indicating vacuum inside.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**Why should you avoid soaking fresh fruit in water before canning?**



## ANSWER

**Soaking lowers quality and increases risk of spoilage**

## FUN FACT

*Washing in cool running water or multiple rinses is safer for fruit texture.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits





**Q**

**What happens if a jar is overfilled, leaving too little headspace before water bath canning fruit?**



## ANSWER

**Some contents may bubble out, preventing a proper seal**

## FUN FACT

*Correct headspace helps exhaust air and forms a safe vacuum seal during processing.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**When canning Asian pears, what is added to the jars to ensure safety due to lower acidity?**



Adults

## ANSWER

### Bottled lemon juice

## FUN FACT

*Adding lemon juice boosts acidity, preventing microbial growth in low-acid fruits.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

**Q**

**How can you test a freshly canned fruit jar for a vacuum seal?**



## ANSWER

**Press the center of the lid and check for no movement**

## FUN FACT

*Another test is tapping the lid - a clear ringing indicates a good seal.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**What is a disadvantage of raw pack canning compared to hot pack?**



## ANSWER

**Fruit texture is firmer but there is more floating fruit**

## FUN FACT

*Raw pack has shorter preparation but can lead to less visually appealing canned fruit.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits





Q

**What do you do if water in a boiling water canner stops boiling during fruit processing?**



## ANSWER

**Bring water back to a boil and restart the timing process**

## FUN FACT

*Continuous boiling ensures fruits are safely processed at proper temperature.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

**Why should jars be cooled on a rack or cloth after canning instead of cold surfaces?**



## ANSWER

**To allow air circulation and prevent jar breakage**

## FUN FACT

*Avoid cold drafts that can cause jar lids to loosen or food spoilage.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



**Q**

**What is one reason why some white-flesh peaches should not be canned by boiling water canning?**



## ANSWER

**They may have a natural pH that is too high to ensure safety**

## FUN FACT

*Freezing is the safe alternative for preserving white-flesh peaches at home.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

**Q**

**What should you do with screw bands on jars after they have cooled and sealed?**



## ANSWER

**Remove screw bands to prevent rusting**

## FUN FACT

*Removing screw bands helps extend the storage life of canned fruit jars.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits